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WHO AM I

- Fourth-year student at the **University of Guelph** in the **BAH Culture and Technology Studies** (CTS) program with a minor in **Studio Art** (practically Fine Arts).
- Here's my [Personal Blog](#)
- The current objective is to create a video game for my capstone project for the CTS program. The project will investigate how AI can be integrated into game development to enhance creativity without undermining authorship, labour, or morality.

THE IDEA

An amateur detective mystery game set at a summer camp. The player starts uncovering the hidden cult within the camp by doing their job (maintaining the property) and interacting with NPCs.

- Kids at the camp are barely worth interacting with and can't be harmed.
 - E.g., "I hear it's chicken caesar wraps for lunch; my favourite!" "I'm late to Archery." "How long 'till the bathroom's clean?"
- Certain NPCs are really good at deflecting questions; others you shouldn't ask questions at all, lest you lose the game (get "asked to leave" or disposed of).
- Cult behaviours that're disguised as camp rituals: Flaming H, Candle ceremony (like a baptism), sing-along lunches, 'Service without recognition,' checking cottagers/outsideers for passes, fires (and the songs that go along with it), giant JESUS SAVES billboard on the highway into the camp
- If your dialogue is suspicious, you can get "caught," and all NPCs in the know chase you down, and if they touch you, you get sedated and ritualized.
 - Can only escape this fate by running successfully

IMPORTANT LINKS:

[PROJECT LOG](#)

[OLD INDEX](#)

[WORKPLAN](#)

[RESEARCH PAPER](#)

[HOST SITE REPOSITORY](#)

[GAME REPOSITORY](#)

[The Hollyburn Moral Compass Project \(HOST SITE\)](#)

[LINK TO FUNCTIONAL GAME](#) (Password: cts)

CHOOSING THE TOOLS:

There were a few options available for how to make this game that I must sift through to find what's best for my project:

- **Hard-coded from scratch**
 - CSS and HTML, Python, etc.
 - (Would be good for Co-creation with AI if I were more skilled with coding.)
- **AI Development tool**
 - *Base44*
 - (Too AI-dominant to be considered co-creation in my eyes.)
 - *Figma*
 - (Also, too AI-dominant to be considered co-creation.)
- **Other Programs/Engines**
 - *Inform7*
 - (A bit old and a unique learning curve.)
 - *Godot*
 - (Promising.)
 - *GameMaker*
 - (Also promising but a little rudimentary.)
 - *Unity*
 - (Difficult learning curve, but might be a fun challenge.)
 - *Unreal Engine*
 - (Extremely difficult learning curve, but might also be a fun challenge.)

While I would love to learn more advanced industry-standard engines, like Unity or Unreal Engine, that would drastically change the scope of my project. Though it would be best for extrapolating my project's findings to a larger scale (AAA Studios). However, another amateur-friendly but respected platform that remains within my scope could just be scaled further. Therefore, I'm going to take a crack at **Godot**. It seems easier than Unreal Engine, but difficult enough to be a nice challenge. Since I'm looking to make a mystery game set in a Camp, here's the To Do list:

- Make a small outdoor environment.
 - Grass, trees, paths?
- 2D game
- Create the main character
- Create different NPCs
- Create buildings like the ones at my old camp

LEARNING GODOT:

[Godot Docs](#)

I started my Godot journey with a [free course in learning GDScript](#) (Godot's language). It took about 2 hours for me, and helped to reacquaint myself with coding and get introduced to this new language. From there, I followed a tutorial for making [Your First 2D Game](#) by Godot. It took a while, but I can potentially adapt the practice game into a minigame for my project.

After that, I created a new project to start fresh. Using ChatGPT at first and eventually Claude, I had a structure (scenes and node trees) for my project and a helpful "friend" (Claude)

to walk me through everything I didn't know, as if it were a real-time Godot Docs or tutorial. Because of that, I'll continue the timeline in the AI Use Documented section below.

ASSETS USED:

Asset pack used to design the map:

<https://cupnooble.itch.io/sprout-lands-asset-pack> (All map features)

Player in underwear animated sprite:

https://www.sprisers-resource.com/pc_computer/stardewvalley/asset/157818/

(If I publish this game, this asset will have to be replaced.)

First Camper NPC animated sprite:

<https://devworm.itch.io/survival-game-godot-4-series-art> (Human worker Red)

Oliver, Hannah, and Ryan's animated sprites & some furniture:

<https://limezu.itch.io/moderninteriors/devlog/244045/free-version-overview-18042021-up-date>

Woody's animated sprites: <https://runninblood.itch.io/16x16-top-down-character>

(A little short for an adult, but I'll just write that into his character sheet.)

AI USE DOCUMENTED:

After I finished the practice game, I went to ChatGPT to structure the main game and take the first step. Starting a creative project with AI is detrimental; however, it is less so than delaying it because of how daunting it seems. So, I went to ChatGPT.

Here is a link to the conversation with ChatGPT where I received help with the initial node tree structure of my project, some early-day code that was later altered, and troubleshooting:

<https://chatgpt.com/share/69a7427f-212c-800e-a670-73b3f7dc7d0d>.

Though the troubleshooting with ChatGPT wasn't great, and I was still having problems with the player's physics. So, I thought I would give Claude a try. I was blown away by how helpful it was: <https://claude.ai/share/395a280d-0e10-4b3a-a2c6-407e0bda9075>.

After half a YouTube tutorial on making my NPC camper, and another way-too-brief video on how to have AI dialogue NPCs in a Godot game, I needed some help walking me through doing it myself. So, I started a new chat with the prompt "How do I use Eidolon AI and an OpenAI API key to make my Godot NPC character have tailored AI responses?"

<https://claude.ai/share/c908ff36-3347-4e61-8ca4-4910b6a612d5>

During this chat, I also purchased an OpenAI API key. I added \$20 worth of token funds, which might have been overkill.

The next conversation with Claude allowed me to successfully implement the following: An inventory system for when players collect clues. Two clues to the game that the player can pick up and log. A help and controls menu accessible from the top left of the game window. A tally of the number of clues the player can collect (eventually 5, though they weren't yet implemented). A minimap of the game with markers and a live indicator of where the player is as they move around. Updating the changes I made to the camper NPC character sheet to the Eidolon Client. Here's the link to the full conversation:

<https://claude.ai/share/4cd9c11e-aecd-4d70-a71f-23ce7740d526>.

The next conversation with Claude allowed me to successfully implement the following: improvements to NPC behaviour, temporary character sheets, and an update to the Eidolon Client. I also sourced free animated NPC sprites for use as assets. Additional progress included help with interactive bathrooms and scene transitions, creating a title screen, and updating the game window to a larger size, along with troubleshooting the issues that came with that change. Finally, Claude and I set up a GitHub repository for the game, as well as a GitHub-hosted site repository with a design Claude based on the title screen. Here's the link to the full conversation:

<https://claude.ai/share/e2b76a14-0255-4a53-a318-0c70000b280b>

Here's the prompt I gave to Claude to draft the little Star Wars-like preamble in the title screen:

"You were a camper for a few years but last year you came home missing some things (particularly one work boot, "How does someone lose 1 boot?"), having a vague memory of the last few weeks you were there, and a note to yourself in your journal saying "there's something going on here, I should have a look around..." But, strangely, feeling overall good towards camp despite all that and wanting to come back. With a year to reflect on how odd it was, you're coming back this year as a second-year property staff with a purpose: get to the bottom of what's going on here."

In practically every script file, I comment that Claude had written most—if not all—of the code, and I would link the Claude conversation that led to that code. Those links are at the top of each script.



```
File Edit Search Go To Debug game_state.gd Online Docs Search Help <
1 extends Node
2 # CODE MADE BY CLAUDE: https://claude.ai/share/44f4d17a-49c0-46f3-86f2-e3b534911db8
3 # Spawn points
4 var spawn_id: String = "default"
5 # Player stats (expand as needed)
6 var player_health: int = 100
7 # Quest/story flags
8 var flags: Dictionary = {}
9 # Inventory (we'll expand this later)
10 var inventory: Array = []
```

After just a few lengthy conversations with Claude (and a little ChatGPT in the early days), we had built the functional game. If you would like to see more details on the game-making process, check out the [PROJECT LOG](#). Presently, the game lacks a proper end but is accessible [HERE](#) if you use the password “cts” just make sure you use fullscreen as [itch.io](#) made the page oddly large.

Eidolon AI Setup:

For anyone who may use Eidolon as I have, here are the most significant terminal commands I used. Also, note that you **need Docker**; I wasted hours troubleshooting without realizing it. Please don't use any of my personal information you may glean from this insight into my terminal.

```
(base) iain@mecano desktop % cd my-npc-server
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % touch npc_agent.yaml
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd desktop
(base) iain@mecano desktop % cd my-npc-server
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % li
zsh: command not found: li
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % ls
resources
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd resources
(base) iain@mecano resources % ls
camperNPC.yaml
(base) iain@mecano resources % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % ls -R /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server
resources

/Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources:
camperNPC.yaml
(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server
eidolon-server --resources /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources
usage: eidolon-server [-h] [-p PORT] [-r] [--debug] [-m MACHINE] [--record]
                    [--disable-metrics DISABLE_METRICS]
                    [--fail-on-bad-agent FAIL_ON_BAD_AGENT]
                    [--dotenv DOTENV] [--dotenv-override] [--watch WATCH]
                    yaml_path [yaml_path ...]
eidolon-server: error: unrecognized arguments: --resources
(base) iain@mecano my-npc-server % cd
(base) iain@mecano ~ % eidolon-server /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources/camperNPC.y
aml
INFO:      Started server process [69142]

(base) iain@mecano ~ % cd agent-machine
(base) iain@mecano agent-machine % cp /Users/iain/Desktop/my-npc-server/resources/camperNPC.yaml
resources/
(base) iain@mecano agent-machine % make docker-serve
```

VIRTUES ESTABLISHED:

The goal I mentioned in the “WHO AM I?” section was a brief, crude explanation of the purpose of this game for this project. I set out to showcase the cool innovations and possibilities of AI in game development under a framework that calms the playerbase's nerves. Largely inspired by the backlash Halo Studios received after announcing they were using AI in the franchise's next release, I wanted to develop a framework that both parties can agree on. Hopefully, in the future, there can be a stamp of authenticity for games developed with AI ethically, potentially following the virtues listed below. These virtues are piggybacked off of Shannon Vallor's “Technomoral virtues” (2016), which I wrote about and properly cited in my [RESEARCH PAPER](#). The project followed a practice-based research methodology; as I developed the game, I would better understand how to make a reasonable ethical framework.

Vallor helped me realize that virtue ethics is a great fit for rapidly evolving technologies like AI, since rule-based ethics can't keep up. Here are the virtues as they relate to my game:

R Responsibility The use of AI clearly and reasonably improves the game quality. No predatory use, especially regarding finances.	T Transparency Players told when they encounter predominantly AI content. Developer's prompts and AI's outputs stored and publicly accessible.
A Auditability All AI use verifiable by a third party — no stone left unturnable. Both successful and failed outputs retained.	I Incorruptibility Narrative boundaries like character sheets largely prevent rogue AI authorship.
P Predictability AI NPC behaviour should be consistent if player prompts are consistent, and unique dialogue from unique prompts.	L Labour Human labour for creative work like art or plot. No AI image generation; unethical. Use art from artists.

These descriptions of the virtues are in relation to my game and thus not quite scalable to larger studios. However, the core titles of the virtues can be: R, A, P, T, I, L. Hypothetically, for the stamp, a studio can propose their game and how it will use AI and receive these virtues' descriptions tweaked to their game by an authenticator. I am in no place to suggest the template for these fairly subjective virtues (by name alone) as I am no philosopher, though I do take a small stab at it in my research paper. Ultimately, I hope a qualified person or group will be inspired by this project and piggyback on my work.